

Due on Tuesday, March 12th.

If pictures are needed/relevant, please provide them with your solutions.

----- ★ -----

1. The electrostatic field is $\mathbf{E} = \alpha x \hat{i} + \alpha y \hat{j}$ in some region of space. Here α is a positive constant.
 - (a) [2 pts.] Show that this satisfies the requirement of zero curl.
 - (b) [3 pts.] Using Maxwell's first equation, find the electric charge density ρ in this region of space. How does ρ vary in space in this region?
 - (c) [3 pts.] Calculate the difference of electric potential between the points $(1, 5, -1)$ and $(1, 5, +1)$.
 - (d) [5 pts.] Calculate the difference of electric potential between the points $(0, 5, 0)$ and $(2, 5, 0)$.

2. A charged sphere has radius a_0 and volume charge density $\rho = \rho_0(r/a_0)$, where r is the distance from the center of the sphere.
 - (a) [4 pts.] What is the total electric flux through any closed surface surrounding the sphere?
Hint: Use Gauss' law (Gauss' dielectric flux theorem). You will need to first calculate the total charge on the sphere.
 - (b) [4 pts.] Using Gauss' law, find the electric field outside the sphere.
 - (c) [5 pts.] Using Gauss' law, find the electric field inside the sphere.
 - (d) [3 pts.] Plot the magnitude of the electric field as a function of r . The plot should extend from $r = 0$ to $r = 2a_0$.
 - (e) [6 pts.] Calculate the electric potential as a function of r , both outside the sphere and inside the sphere. You can take $r = \infty$ as the reference, i.e., the potential at infinite distance can be taken to be zero.

3. Recall that the current through a surface (e.g., through a cross-section of a current-carrying wire) is the surface integral of the current density.
- (a) **[3 pts.]** A current I is uniformly distributed over the cross-section of a wire. The cross-section is circular, with radius R . Find the current density J , as a function of I and R .
- (b) **[5 pts.]** Now consider instead the situation that the current density is larger near the outer region of the wire cross-section than at the center: $J = kr$, where r is the radial distance from the center of the wire. Find the current I , as a function of k and R . You will probably need to do a two-dimensional integral in polar coordinates. (In two-dimensional polar coordinates, the area element is $dS = r dr d\theta$.)
4. A copper conductor has 8.5×10^{28} electrons per cubic meter available to carry current, i.e., the carrier density is $8.5 \times 10^{28} \text{m}^{-3}$. The drift velocity is found to be $3 \times 10^{-6} \text{m/s}$.
- (a) **[0 pts.]** Look up and report the charge of an electron in SI units.
- (b) **[3 pts.]** Calculate the current density J .
5. **[4 pts.]** The current density in some region is found to be

$$\mathbf{J} = \frac{K_0 y}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \hat{i} - \frac{K_0 x}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \hat{j}$$

Use the continuity equation to show that the charge density in this region does not change with time.